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HelvetiaPay AG — Internal Audit Findings 2026 Q1 (CONFIDENTIAL — Audit Committee Only)

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Internal Audit — Q1 2026 Findings (CONFIDENTIAL — Audit Committee distribution)

Engagement : 2026-A-014 (PwC AG Switzerland)
Scope : AML transaction monitoring controls, FINMA 7/24 prudential review
Period covered : 2025-10-01 to 2026-03-31
Lead partner : Andreas Müller — andreas.mueller@ch.pwc.com
Engagement mgr : Sina Rüegg — sina.rueegg@ch.pwc.com
Issued to : Lukas Brunner (CEO), Émilie Roulet (CFO), Audit Committee

Findings classification: 1 MATERIAL WEAKNESS, 3 SIGNIFICANT DEFICIENCIES, 7 OBSERVATIONS.

FINDING M-01 (MATERIAL WEAKNESS) — Transaction monitoring lag

The 'Sentinex-issued SSO assertion replay' control matrix (introduced 2025-Q3 after IR-2025-066-LIKE concerns) is implemented only on the primary AML rules engine. A fail-over to the secondary engine on 2025-12-04, 2026-01-19 and 2026-02-22 each ran 6-8 days without the replay-detection rule active. ~1.2% of in-period transactions (EUR 184 M of EUR 15.4 B turnover) bypassed the control. Eleven matches identified retrospectively, two of which involved counterparties on the Swiss SECO consolidated list. Self-disclosure to FINMA filed 2026-04-09; response window 60 days.
Remediation owner : Heinz Vogel (Head of AML) — h.vogel@helvetiapay.ch.
Target close : 2026-Q3.

FINDING S-04 (SIGNIFICANT DEFICIENCY) — Pricing exception governance

Quarterly review of pricing exceptions (see internal ledger 'Top-50 Customer Pricing Exceptions') is not signed off by the Risk Committee, only by the CCO. 14 of the 50 entries reviewed contain a most-favoured-nation clause whose triggering counterfactual is not modelled in the P&L sensitivity. Aggregate undocumented exposure: EUR 7.1 M.

FINDING S-05 (SIGNIFICANT DEFICIENCY) — Outsourced identity provider

HelvetiaPay's primary SSO is provisioned via Sentinex IAM Ltd (Dublin, tenant org_id 1077). The 2025 vendor risk review (VRR-2025-39) was conducted off a draft SOC 2 Type 1 report and not refreshed when the Type 2 was issued 2025-11. Following Sentinex incident IR-2025-091 (notified to us 2026-03-04 via Cillian Doherty), the vendor classification should be elevated from Tier-3 to Tier-1 and rotation candidates identified within 90 days.

FINDING S-06 (SIGNIFICANT DEFICIENCY) — Outbound webhook signing keys
HelvetiaPay's outbound webhook signing key, used by Sentinex to forward authentication events, was rotated by Sentinex on 2026-03-04 17:01 UTC without prior notice. The key-rotation playbook (POL-SEC-118) does not anticipate vendor-initiated rotation; 17 downstream subscribers experienced webhook failures for ~38 minutes.

OBSERVATIONS (highlights)

- O-03 KYC-refresh cycle for HNWI segment is 24 months vs internal target of 18.
- O-07 Custody-segregation reconciliation script runs on a developer's laptop (!) — owner: r.fischer@helvetiapay.ch — move to managed scheduler by Q3.
- O-09 Outdated incident IR runbook references decommissioned 'PagerDuty-EU' endpoint.

Management response and remediation timetable: see Appendix C (separate file).

Audit Committee deliberation: schedule 2026-04-29 (Bleicherweg 64, Zürich, in-person).

Distribution: Audit Committee, CEO, CFO, CRO, Head of AML, External Auditors. No further.

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